All this looks dreary, and our democracy clock is close to midnight, but in fact all the polls show that more than half the population is against the policy being pushed through the Knesset, and probably against the present parliamentary majority, as well. The weekly demonstrations are immensely encouraging: they are saving the country's honor. But they cannot in and of themselves stop the self-interested politicians and crazy fanatics. Civil disobedience is the most powerful democratic way of influencing the course of politics, and thank God that it is spreading. Such resolve of some of the best among us should give hope to all and restore our confidence in the coming of better days.

Some of you may have seen, in a recent article in *Haaretz*, a quote from Victor Klemperer's diary, written shortly after the Nazis came to power: "Naked violence and horrible hypocrisy find their expression in official ordinances … Nobody breathes freely anymore … More than fear, I feel shame … For the first time, I feel political hatred against a whole group." And Klemperer added "deadly hatred," words that, I hope, we will never have to use here.

I will end with that.

However, let me pursue this trend of thoughts for a while. If, over a period of years, it becomes obvious that Israel cannot be peacefully accepted by a Palestinian independent entity or state, notwithstanding external guarantees, then defense measures will become unavoidable. But legitimate self-defense is fundamentally different from a divine right of domination over the whole of Eretz Israel. One may argue, of course, that from the outset Zionism laid claim to the whole of Eretz Israel—a divine promise for some, historical rights for others. But let us admit it: from the outset, the sacred formula "Jewish and democratic" was an illusion, only defensible by dint of twisted logic.

Let's get back to the present. Nahum Barnea, a veteran Israeli political commentator, wrote in today's *Yedioth Ahronoth*: "The government needs to